Quod Iam Diu

Benedict XV · 1918-12-01 · English

Benedict XV and the Peace Conference

AN ENcYCLICAL LETTER.

ENERABL E Brothers, Health and Apostolic Bene- diction: That which the entire world has so long sighed for, what Christianity implored with so much fervent prayer, and what We, the interpreter of the sor-

row of all, with the heart of a father, continually kept asking for, has come in a moment. The clang of arms has ceased at last. It is true that peace has not yet for- mally put an end to the war. However, with the armis- tice, which has meantime suspended carnage and devas- tation by land, sea and air, the road to peace is for- tunately clear.

In order to explain-such a sudden event several causes might be adduced. But if we want to seek the principal cause, we absolutely must look to Him who governs all occurrences, who led to mercy by the continual prayers of the good, granted humanity to withdraw from so many struggles and so many causes of anguish. There- fore, while giving thanks to the goodness of the Lord, we rejoice at the many imposing demonstrations of piety that have been held throughout the Catholic world for the purpose.

Now it remains to us to beg of Divine Clemency that the great favor granted to us may have. its crowning success. Within a short time the delegates of the several nations will unite in solemn congress for the purpose of giving to the world a just and lasting peace. They will accordingly have to come to decisions of such grave

importance and of so complex a nature as were never before taken by any human assembly.

It is then not necessary to point out how imperative it is that they receive light from above in order to exe- cute properly their mandate. And since there is ques- tion of decisions that concern the weal of all humanity to the highest degree, without any doubt all Catholics, who are in conscience bound to favor order and the progress of civilization, have the obligation of invoking the Divine aid for those who take part in the Peace Con- ference. We wish this duty to be remembered by all Catholics. Therefore, Venerable Brothers, in order that the fruit of the approaching congress may be: that great gift of heaven, which is true peace founded upon the Christian principles of justice, it will be your care to an- nounce public prayers in each parish of your respective dioceses in that form which you will consider timely, to implore for it the light of the Heavenly Father.

As far as We Ourselves are concerned, representing, however unworthily, Jesus Christ, the King of Peace, We shall use all the influence of Our apostolic ministry so that the decisions that may be arrived at for the pur- pose of perpetuating tranquillity, good order and con- cord in the world may be accepted and faithfully fol- lowed everywhere by Catholics.

As a token of heavenly favor and as an earnest of Our benevolence, We impart to you, Venerable Brothers, to your clergy and people the Apostolic Blessing.

Given at St. Peter's, Rome, December 1, 1918, in the f.fith year of Our Pontificate.

BENEpIcT XV, P. P.

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